

C2 Proficiency (CPE):Vocabulary List

ENVIRONMENT AND SUSTAINABILITY	
anthropogenic	originating in human activity
pernicious	having a harmful effect, especially in a gradual or subtle way
ubiquitous	present, appearing, or found everywhere
sequester	isolate or hide away
remediation	the action of remedying something, in particular of reversing or stopping environmental damage
effluent	liquid waste or sewage discharged into a river or the sea
biome	a large naturally occurring community of flora and fauna occupying a major habitat
pristine	in its original condition; unspoiled
denude	strip something of its covering, possessions, or assets
inexhaustible	(of a supply or amount) incapable of being used up
ecological niche	the role and position a species has in its environment
albedo effect	the proportion of the incident light or radiation that is reflected by a surface
cataclysmic	(of a natural event) large-scale and violent
decompose	(with reference to a dead body or other organic matter) make or become rotten
extirpate	eradicate or destroy completely
imperiled	put at risk of being harmed, injured, or destroyed

contaminant	a polluting or poisonous substance that makes something impure
stratospheric thinning	reduction in the thickness of the ozone layer in the stratosphere
cryosphere	the frozen water part of the Earth system
reforestation	the natural or intentional restocking of existing forests and woodlands that have been depleted
marshland	low-lying land that is flooded in wet seasons or at high tide, and typically remains waterlogged at all times
nanoplastic	extremely small pieces of plastic debris in the environment resulting from the disposal and breakdown of consumer products
biocapacity	the capacity of ecosystems to regenerate what people demand from those surfaces
unsustainable harvesting	the removal of resources at a rate faster than they can be replenished
amelioration	the act of making something better; improvement
acclimatization	the process of becoming accustomed to a new climate or new conditions

ARTS AND HUMANITIES

metaphorical	characteristic of or relating to metaphor; figurative
porcelain	a white vitrified translucent ceramic; china
lithograph	a print made by lithography
sublime discernment	elevated judgment in perceiving beauty or grandeur
cultural edification	intellectual, moral, or aesthetic improvement through culture

connoisseur	an expert judge in matters of taste
expressive conduit	a channel for conveying creative expression
artistic immersion	deep involvement in creative endeavors
plastic arts	art forms that involve physical manipulation of a plastic medium by molding or modeling
dramatic arts	forms of narrative performance involving acting
philistine	a person who is hostile or indifferent to culture and the arts
prototype initiative	an initial model or trial project
erudite	having or showing great knowledge or learning
cubism	an early 20th-century style and movement in art in which multiple perspectives of a person or object are depicted in a single picture
postmodernism	a late-20th-century style and concept in the arts characterized by distrust of theories and ideologies and by the drawing of attention to conventions
fresco	a painting done rapidly in watercolor on wet plaster on a wall or ceiling
frieze	a broad horizontal band of sculpted or painted decoration
patrimony	property inherited from one's father or male ancestor
carnival	a public festival, typically during the period before Lent in Roman Catholic countries, involving processions, music, dancing, and the use of masquerade
literary canon	the works of literature considered to be established as being of the highest quality and most enduring value

SCIENCE AND INNOVATION

fission	the action of dividing or splitting something into two or more parts
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profligate	recklessly extravagant or wasteful in the use of resources
transgenic	of, relating to, or containing a gene or genes transferred from another species
vanguard	a position at the forefront of new developments or ideas
corroboration	evidence that confirms or supports a statement, theory, or finding
subatomic	occurring within or smaller than an atom
viscosity	the state of being thick, sticky, and semifluid in consistency, due to internal friction
phylogeny	the evolutionary history of a kind of organism
proteome	the entire complement of proteins that is or can be expressed by a cell, tissue, or organism
polymorphism	the condition of occurring in several different forms
qubit	a unit of quantum information
systemic prejudice	inherent unfairness embedded in processes or institutions
heuristic approaches	methods enabling a person to discover or learn something for themselves
contrivance	a thing that is created skillfully and inventively to serve a particular purpose
biotechnology	the exploitation of biological processes for industrial and other purposes
epiphany	a moment of sudden and great revelation or realization
macromolecule	a molecule containing a very large number of atoms, such as a protein, nucleic acid, or synthetic polymer
precautions	measures taken in advance to prevent something dangerous, unpleasant, or inconvenient from happening

RECREATION AND ATHLETICS

ford	cross a river where it is shallow
novice	a person new to or inexperienced in a field or situation
respirator	an apparatus worn over the mouth and nose or the entire face to prevent the inhalation of dust, smoke, or other noxious substances
decathlon	an athletic event comprising ten track-and-field events
pinnacle achievement	the highest point or level of success
arduous regimen	a demanding and rigorous routine of physical activity
avocational pursuits	activities engaged in for enjoyment outside one's occupation
contests	events in which people compete for supremacy in a sport or other activity
wellness vogues	current fashions in maintaining physical health
bricolage	construction or creation from a diverse range of available things
discretionary period	time free from obligations or duties
all-inclusive vacation	a holiday where all elements are prepaid and included in the price
adrenaline pursuits	activities involving high risk and excitement
in-line skating	skating using skates with wheels arranged in a single line
aquatic exploration	underwater diving using self-contained breathing apparatus
trekking	a long arduous journey, typically on foot
ten-pin	a form of bowling using ten pins

asana practice	the physical postures of yoga
trotting	running at a moderate pace
ascension	the act of rising to an important position or a higher level

WELLNESS AND MEDICINE

nocebo	a detrimental effect on health produced by psychological or psychosomatic factors
pandemic	(of a disease) prevalent over a whole country or the world
psychological resilience	the ability to mentally or emotionally cope with a crisis
dietetics	the branch of knowledge concerned with the diet and its effects on health
morbid obesity	a serious health condition that can interfere with basic physical functions
therapeutic intervention	an attempt to help someone who is experiencing difficulties
eudaimonia	a state of being happy, healthy, and prosperous
equilibrated nutrition	a diet providing balanced proportions of nutrients
prosthesis	an artificial body part, such as a limb, a heart, or a breast implant
panacea	a solution or remedy for all difficulties or diseases
fret	be constantly or visibly anxious
gravitas	dignity, seriousness, or solemnity of manner
salubrious	health-giving; healthy
heterogeneity	the quality or state of being diverse in character or content

indispensable	absolutely necessary
modicum	a small quantity of a particular thing, especially something desirable or valuable
portions	a part of a whole; an amount, section, or piece of something
eradicate	destroy completely; put an end to
curtail	reduce in extent or quantity; impose a restriction on

SOCIETAL DYNAMICS

marginalization	treatment of a person, group, or concept as insignificant or peripheral
indigence	a level of poverty in which real hardship and deprivation are suffered
refugees	persons who have been forced to leave their country in order to escape war, persecution, or natural disaster
psychological incongruity	mental discomfort arising from conflicting beliefs or attitudes
relational interplay	the way in which two or more people or things interact
deontology	the study of the nature of duty and obligation
forlorn	pitifully sad and abandoned or lonely
dilapidated	(of a building or object) in a state of disrepair or ruin as a result of age or neglect
merit	the quality of being particularly good or worthy, especially so as to deserve praise or reward
estrangement	the fact of no longer being on friendly terms or part of a social group
bigotry	obstinate or unreasonable attachment to a belief, opinion, or faction
disparity	a great difference

bias	inclination or prejudice for or against one person or group
archetype	a very typical example of a certain person or thing
peripheral	of secondary or minor importance; marginal
enfranchisement	the giving of a right or privilege, especially the right to vote
espousal	an act of adopting or supporting a cause, belief, or way of life

PROFESSIONAL AND ECONOMIC SPHERES

apprenticeship	a period of training with a company or organization to learn a skill or trade
advancement	the process of promoting a cause or plan
intrapreneurship	the act of behaving like an entrepreneur while working within a large organization
economic chasm	a profound difference between people, viewpoints, situations, or groups
hierarchical frameworks	systems organized in ranks or levels of authority
labor exchange	the supply of and demand for employed labor
nominate	propose or formally enter as a candidate for election or for an honor or award
synergize	combine or coordinate the activity of two or more agents to produce a joint effect greater than the sum of their separate effects
enlist	enroll or be enrolled in the armed services
appraisal	an act of assessing something or someone
provenance	the place of origin or earliest known history of something

perquisite	a benefit which one enjoys or is entitled to on account of one's job or position
transit	the action of passing through or across a place
downsize	make something smaller
duress	threats, violence, constraints, or other action used to coerce someone into doing something against their will or better judgment
vocation	a person's employment or main occupation, especially regarded as worthy and requiring dedication
employment arena	the economic system in which jobs are offered and labor is exchanged for wages
subordinate	a person under the authority or control of another within an organization
proprietor	the owner of a business
milieu	a person's social environment

LEARNING AND SCHOLARSHIP

perennial education	ongoing learning throughout one's lifetime
scholarly inquiry	systematic investigation conducted in an academic context
doctorate	the highest degree awarded by a graduate school or other approved educational organization
evaluation	the making of a judgment about the amount, number, or value of something
impetus	the force or energy with which a body moves
pedagogical transformations	changes in teaching methods or educational systems
enrollment	the action of enrolling or being enrolled

custodian	a person who has responsibility for taking care of or protecting something
savant	a learned person, especially a distinguished scientist
undergraduate qualification	a degree earned after completing a program of study at a college or university
residential academy	an institution where students reside during terms
remote pedagogy	education conducted via distance methods like online platforms
in-person seminars	traditional classroom-based learning with instructors and peers
tertiary studies	education beyond secondary level, typically at universities
postgraduate credential	advanced degree pursued after a bachelor's
independent institution	school funded through tuition and private sources, not government
public academy	government-funded school offering free education
assignments	tasks assigned as part of a course of study

INTERPERSONAL AND MEDIA CONNECTIONS

maintain correspondence	continue communicating with someone over time
connective phrases	expressions used to link ideas in speech or writing
familial interactions	patterns of behavior within family units
envy	a feeling of discontented or resentful longing aroused by someone else's possessions, qualities, or luck
schmoozing	talk intimately and cozily; gossip
virtual interchange	communication conducted through electronic media

confidant	a person with whom one shares a secret or private matter
consort	a wife, husband, or companion, in particular the spouse of a reigning monarch
ward	a child or young person under the care and control of a guardian appointed by their parents or a court
individual flair	a distinctive and stylish elegance
become enamored	be filled with love for
quarrel	have a heated argument or disagreement
establish contact	initiate communication with someone
harmonize	add notes to a melody to produce harmony
reconcile	restore friendly relations between
betroth	enter into a formal agreement to marry
associate	a partner or companion in business or at work

EXPLORATION AND MOBILITY

stopover	a break in a journey
elevation	the action or fact of raising or being raised to a higher or more important level, state, or position
foray	a short journey or trip, especially one taken as a leisure activity
perilous journeying	travel involving risk or danger
intercultural reciprocity	mutual exchange between different cultures
touristic ramifications	consequences arising from tourism activities

vacation anecdotes	short accounts of interesting or humorous incidents from holidays
logistical hurdles	problems related to the organization of movement
disconnect digitally	cease using electronic devices for communication
eschew convention	deliberately avoid using; abstain from
embark on aviation	board an aircraft for travel
reserve lodging	book accommodation in advance
fail transit	miss a connecting mode of transport
devise route	create a detailed plan for travel
escorted excursion	a tour accompanied by an expert leader
panoramic vista	a wide and unobstructed view of an extensive area
chartered voyage	a flight or trip arranged for a specific group

GLOBAL ECONOMICS AND POLITICS

commerce	the activity of buying and selling, especially on a large scale
international frictions	conflicts arising from political geography
altruistic assistance	help provided to relieve suffering without selfish motive
viable progress	development that is capable of being maintained over time
disparity	a great difference
insolvent	unable to pay debts owed
penniless	without any money; completely poor
equity	the value of the shares issued by a company

contraction	the process of becoming smaller
hyperinflation	monetary inflation occurring at a very high rate
shortfall	a deficit of something required or expected
glut	an excessively abundant supply of something
embargoes	official bans on trade or other commercial activity with a particular country
levy	impose a tax, fee, or fine
interconnectivity	the state of being connected with each other
statecraft	the skillful management of state affairs; statesmanship

CHRONOLOGY AND ROUTINES

assiduous	showing great care and perseverance
extracurricular	(of an activity at a school or college) pursued in addition to the normal course of study
recreational interval	period dedicated to relaxation and enjoyment
habitual patterns	regular and repeated ways of behaving
quinzaine	a period of fifteen days
witching hour	midnight, when witches are supposedly active
dilly-dally	waste time through aimless wandering or indecision
concurrent execution	performing multiple tasks simultaneously
perambulate	walk or travel through or around a place or area
aurora	the dawn in the morning

crepuscule	twilight
rotational labor	work performed in scheduled shifts
equilibrium between spheres	balance between professional and personal life
inactivity phase	period of rest or non-productivity
rush period	time of maximum activity or demand
desynchronosis	disruption of a person's circadian rhythm following long-distance travel